

Dev's First Day of School

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Dev was a small boy, four years old.

Tomorrow was his first day of school.

He felt nervous.

His tummy felt fluttery.

His hands felt sweaty.

"What if I do not know anyone?" he asked.

"What if I miss Mama?"

Mama sat with him on the bed.

She said, "I see you feel nervous."

Dev nodded.

"It is okay to feel nervous," Mama said.

"New things feel big at first."

She packed his bag with him.

A lunchbox.

Crayons.



A soft handkerchief that smelled like home.

She said, "Brave does not mean not scared. Brave means trying."

"Brave does not mean not scared. Brave means trying," she said again.

"Brave does not mean not scared. Brave means trying," she said one more time.

Dev held the words in his heart.

The next morning, they walked to school.

Dev held Mama's hand tight.

At the gate, a kind teacher smiled.

"Welcome, Dev," she said.

The classroom had bright pictures.



It had blocks and books.

A little girl waved at Dev.

"Come sit with me," she said.

Dev felt nervous still.

But he tried.

He sat down.

He built a tall block tower.

He drew a blue elephant.

At lunch, he ate beside his new friend.

The day went fast.

Faster than he thought.

When Mama came, Dev ran to her.

"I did it!" he said.

"I was nervous, and I tried!"

Mama hugged him so tight.



"I am so proud of you," she said.

That night, Dev put his bag by the door.

Ready for tomorrow.

He felt nervous yesterday.

Now he felt brave.

He snuggled under his blanket.

Mama kissed his forehead.

The moon smiled through the window.

Dev closed his eyes.

He was brave.

He was loved.

Goodnight, Dev.

Moral: *Feeling nervous is normal — trying anyway is what makes us brave.*

The End